



Across

- 1** Briefly, the state that just became a tipping point for the presidential election and control of the senate. (2)
- 3** One of the most reliable places to find a game of pickup, especially *when you're in a new town*. (4)
- 5** Artest (in 2009) and Mayo (2016) injured themselves falling down these. (6)
- 7** First *and* last name of once-beloved Mavericks eventually spurned by Mark Cuban. (8)

- 3** The abbreviated answer you don't want to hear when asking, "Am I the *ssh*le?" (3)
- 4** Malone sans his K, or Landry sans his C? (3)
- 5** Initials of the Heat forward whose unkempt appearance in the 2020 playoffs made him the meme-able face of quarantine life in Orlando. (2)
- 6** The opposite cardinal directions of the eldest child to failed presidential candidate, Kanye. (2)

Down

- 1** The less creative half of the Wizards' mascot duo. (4)
- 2** Phil Jackson said an early '70s trip on this helped him see "enlightened basketball". (4)